

Sunday, 6 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 26° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 25° 14°	MANCHESTER Light rain 23° 14°	GLASGOW Drizzle 20° 15°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Port of Dover has seen hours of disruption after a 'stop the boats' protest caused major traffic issues.

The government has condemned the behaviour, which led to significant delays for travellers. Police were on scene to manage the situation.

PROTEST · UK
- 2

Reform UK leader Nigel Farage says he 'wasn't listening' during foreign donor talks that were filmed undercover.

Mr Farage was speaking to Laura Kuenssberg, where he also revealed his family are 'begging' him to step down from his role. The party is facing scrutiny over its funding.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Jaguar Land Rover has confirmed it will be cutting jobs as part of a major cost-saving plan.

The car manufacturer aims to save around £1.7 billion over the next two years. This news follows a period of financial restructuring for the company.

BUSINESS · UK
- 4

A new police team is being set up to tackle illegal number plates across England.

The initiative will see forces working together to target organised crime groups and drivers attempting to avoid fines. It's hoped this will improve road safety and enforcement.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The King and Queen have joined thousands of fans at the annual Braemar Gathering in Scotland.

They watched traditional Highland events including dancing, caber tossing, and pipe bands. The annual event is a highlight in the Royal calendar.

ROYALTY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Jay-Z's highly anticipated UK show in London saw a host of surprise guests including Lauryn Hill and Wyclef Jean.**
The US rapper treated fans to over two hours of hits, bringing out some legendary names. It was the first of his two shows in the capital.
| ON AIR – What's the best surprise guest you've ever seen at a gig, and who was it?
MUSIC · TODAY
- 2 Gavin and Stacey star Rob Brydon has expressed regret at turning down an interview with Dolly Parton.**
The comedian visited Dollywood as part of his TV series. He reflected on the missed opportunity during a recent chat.
| ON AIR – If you could interview any music legend, who would it be and why?
TV · PAST
- 3 Oasis fans believe they've cracked the code for upcoming gigs at Celtic Park, thanks to a chip shop video.**
Internet sleuths spotted numbers on posters in the video, which they believe are map coordinates for the Glasgow stadium. This has fuelled speculation about the band's future plans.
| ON AIR – Are you an Oasis fan, and would you travel for a reunion gig?
MUSIC · FUTURE
- 4 A striking new Freddie Mercury mural has been unveiled at Wembley Park, celebrating the Queen frontman.**
The artwork is anamorphic, meaning the image only fully resolves when viewed from a specific spot. It's a fantastic tribute to the music icon.
| ON AIR – What's your favourite Queen song, and why does it resonate with you?
ART · TODAY
- 5 Aardman Animations, the creators of Wallace and Gromit, are celebrating 50 years with some fascinating behind-the-scenes secrets.**
They've revealed that Gromit was nearly a cat, and shared stories about the silent Shaun the Sheep. It's a wonderful look back at their iconic work.
| ON AIR – What's your favourite Aardman creation, and why do you love it?
ANIMATION · PAST

On the schedule

1 **Alpine driver Pierre Gasly has taken a stunning pole position at the Italian Grand Prix, beating Mercedes' George Russell.**

It's a fantastic result for Gasly at Monza, putting him in prime position for tomorrow's race. Russell will start alongside him on the front row.

ON AIR – Do you think Gasly can convert this pole into a win at Monza?

F1 · UK

2 **Chelsea's Women's Super League title hopes are already under scrutiny after dropping points in their opener against Aston Villa.**

They were cruising to victory with just minutes left but conceded a late equaliser. It's the first time they've dropped points against Villa in the WSL.

ON AIR – Is this a blip for Chelsea, or a sign of a more competitive WSL season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Alexander Isak scored an early double to give Liverpool a 2-0 victory over Ipswich in their first win of the season.**

Isak netted twice within the opening ten minutes, setting Liverpool on their way. It's a strong start for the Reds under new head coach Andoni Iraola.

ON AIR – After a strong start, do you think Isak will be a key player for Liverpool this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **There are no British players left in the US Open singles, but there might still be reasons to feel positive about UK tennis.**

Another Grand Slam second week passes without British interest in the singles draws. However, some analysts point to promising performances earlier in the tournament.

ON AIR – Are you still following the US Open, and who are you backing to win?

TENNIS · UK

5 **Alexia Putellas made her London City Lionesses debut as they beat Manchester United 2-1 in the Women's Super League opener.**

The Spanish star's highly anticipated debut saw her new side secure a strong victory. It was a thrilling start to the WSL season.

ON AIR – How much impact do you think Alexia Putellas will have on the WSL this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent trend sees more people embracing 'wild swimming' in natural bodies of water.**
Beyond the health benefits, enthusiasts report a deep connection with nature and a feeling of exhilaration, even in cooler temperatures.
- 2 The simple art of 'doodling' is being recognised for its power to boost concentration and creativity.**
Far from a distraction, studies suggest that aimless sketching can help process information and spark new ideas.
- 3 A surge in popularity for 'board game cafes' is transforming social gatherings.**
These welcoming spaces offer a fun, screen-free way for friends and families to connect over classic and new games alike.
- 4 Many are discovering the joy of 'upcycling old furniture' to create unique home decor.**
It's a sustainable and creative way to give pre-loved items a new lease of life, adding character to any room.
- 5 The trend of 'seed saving' is taking root among gardeners across the country.**
It's a rewarding practice that not only preserves heirloom varieties but also offers a cost-effective way to grow next year's produce.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'star gazing' is encouraging people to look up more often.**
Away from city lights, many are finding a sense of wonder and peace in observing the night sky, often with simple binoculars.
- 7 The 'humble biscuit' is experiencing a gourmet makeover, with artisanal bakeries offering sophisticated flavours.**
From exotic spices to unexpected combinations, these elevated treats are making tea time a little more luxurious.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of coffee will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE BEANS OR GROUNDS RIGHT THROUGH THE PACKAGING BEFORE BUYING IT.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ARRANGING THE BISCUITS ON THE PLATE IN A VERY SPECIFIC ORDER.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular aroma' can just make you feel instantly nostalgic or incredibly comforted?
What's that one smell that transports you back to a happy memory, or just makes you feel right at home?
- We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that just make us feel instantly happy or bring a smile to our face, don't we?
Whether it's the kettle whistling or a specific birdsong, what's a small, ordinary sound that always brightens your day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the distinct smell of freshly cut grass is actually a distress signal released by the plants?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that garden gnomes were originally used by ancient civilisations to ward off evil spirits from their crops?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A 'group of ferrets' is called a business.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- It is estimated that more than 200 different species of butterfly exist in the UK.
- The world's largest mushroom forest is actually underground in Oregon, spanning 2,200 acres.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'king penguin' is the second largest species of penguin and can dive to depths of over 300 metres.
- The average cloud weighs about 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.

On this day

Day 249 of the year, 116 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Begga; Christian feast days: Chagnoald; Christian feast days: Faustus, Abibus and Dionysius of Alexandria; Christian feast days: Gondulphus of Metz. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2000 — David Kushner, American singer-songwriter
- 1974 — Justin Whalin, American actor
- 1942 — Mel McDaniel, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 2001 — Freya Allan, English actress
- 1973 — Greg Rusedski, Canadian-English tennis player and sportscaster
- 1947 — Sylvester, American singer-songwriter (died 1988)
- 1980 — Kerry Katona, English singer and actress
- 1978 — Foxy Brown, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.
- 2009 — The ro-ro ferry SuperFerry 9 sinks off the Zamboanga Peninsula in the Philippines with 971 persons aboard; all but ten are rescued.
- 1986 — In Istanbul, two terrorists from Abu Nidal's organization kill 22 and wound six congregants inside the Neve Shalom Synagogue during Shabbat services.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1988 — End of the last stage of the Anfal campaign of Ba'athist Iraq against its Kurdish population, which resulted in major destructions and major civilian losses.
- 1976 — Cold War: Soviet Air Defence Forces pilot Viktor Belenko lands a Mikoyan-Gurevich MiG-25 jet fighter at Hakodate in Japan and requests political asylum in the United States; his request is granted.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1983 — The Soviet Union admits to shooting down Korean Air Lines Flight 007, stating that its operatives did not know that it was a civilian aircraft when it reportedly violated Soviet airspace.

- 2018 — Supreme Court of India decriminalised all consensual sex among adults in private, making homosexuality legal on the Indian lands.
- 2022 — Russo-Ukrainian war: Ukraine begins its Kharkiv counteroffensive, surprising Russian forces and retaking over 3,000 square kilometers of land, recapturing the entire Kharkiv Oblast west of the Oskil River, within the next week.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 250 of the year, 115 days left in 2026. Today Air Force Day (Pakistan); Christian feast day: Anastasius the Fuller; Christian feast day: Clodoald; Christian feast day: Blessed Giovanni Battista Mazzucconi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1956 — Diane Warren, American songwriter
- 1961 — LeRoi Moore, American saxophonist and songwriter (died 2008)
- 1987 — Danny North, English footballer
- 1987 — Sammy Moore, English footballer
- 1986 — Charlie Daniels, English footballer
- 1977 — Jon Macken, English-Irish footballer
- 1956 — Byron Stevenson, Welsh footballer (died 2007)
- 1973 — Shannon Elizabeth, American model and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1977 — The Torrijos–Carter Treaties between Panama and the United States on the status of the Panama Canal are signed. The United States agrees to transfer control of the canal to Panama at the end of the 20th century.
- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is elected first secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1979 — The Chrysler Corporation asks the United States government for US\$1.5 billion to avoid bankruptcy.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Maiden flight of the Lockheed Martin F-22 Raptor.
- 1978 — While walking across Waterloo Bridge in London, Bulgarian dissident Georgi Markov is assassinated by Bulgarian secret police agent Francesco Gullino by means of a ricin pellet fired from a specially designed umbrella.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar